Thomas **Leavitt**

Assistant Professor

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ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS

Baruch College, City University of New York (CUNY) 2023–
Assistant Professor (tenure track), Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Affiliate, CUNY Institute for Demographic Research (CIDR)

Harvard University 2021–2023
Postdoctoral Research Fellow, Harvard Medical School

AFFILIATIONS

Arnold Ventures Criminal Justice Evaluation Network 2026–
Evaluation and Evidence Consulting Fellow

EDUCATION

Columbia University *Ph.D., 2021*
Political Science

Dissertation: "Design-based, Bayesian Causal Inference for the Social Sciences"
Committee: Donald P. Green (chair), Macartan Humphreys (sponsor), Naoki Egami, Jake Bowers (external, University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign), Fredrik Sävje (external, Yale University)

Visiting Affiliation: Harvard University, Ivy Plus Exchange Scholar (2019–2020)

University of Chicago *M.A.*
Committee on International Relations (CIR)

DePauw University *B.A.*
Political Science

PUBLISHED AND FORTHCOMING ARTICLES

Leavitt, T. Beyond Pretrends: A Discordance-Based Sensitivity Analysis for Difference-in-Differences. Accepted at *Observational Studies*. arXiv:2609.19081

Leavitt, T. and L. W. Miratrix. Building a Design-Based Matching Pipeline: From Principles to Practical Implementation in R. Accepted at *Observational Studies*.

Leavitt, T. and V. Rivera-Burgos. (In press). Navigating the Mismeasurement of Intermediary Variables in Message-Based Experiments. *Political Science Research and Methods*, First View. DOI: 10.1017/psrm.2025.10082

Leavitt, T. (2026). Fisher Meets Bayes: The Value of Randomisation for Bayesian Inference of Causal Effects. *International Statistical Review*, 94(1), 188–201. DOI: 10.1111/insr.12598

Leavitt, T. and L. A. Hatfield. (2025). Averaged Prediction Models (APM): Identifying Causal Effects in Controlled Pre-Post Settings with Application to Gun Policy. *The Annals of Applied Statistics*, 19(3), 1826–1846. DOI: 10.1214/25-AOAS2011

Leavitt, T. and V. Rivera-Burgos. (2024). Audit Experiments of Racial Discrimination and the Importance of Symmetry in Exposure to Cues. *Political Analysis*, 32(4), 445–462. DOI: 10.1017/pan.2024.3

Leavitt, T. (2023). Randomization-Based, Bayesian Inference of Causal Effects. *Journal of Causal Inference*, 11(1), 20220025. DOI: 10.1515/jci-2022-0025

PUBLISHED BOOK CHAPTERS

Green, D. P., T. Leavitt, and D. Markovits (2023). Challenges that Proprietary Research Poses for Meta-Analysis. In J. M. Box-Steffensmeier, D. P. Christenson, and V. Sinclair-Chapman (Eds.), Oxford Handbook of Engaged Methodological Pluralism in Political Science, Volume 1, Chapter 18, pp. 257–271. New York, NY: Oxford University Press. Print edition 2026. DOI: 10.1093/oxfordhb/9780192868282.013.21

Bowers, J. and T. Leavitt (2020). Causality and Design-Based Inference. In L. Curini and R. Franzese (Eds.), The SAGE Handbook of Research Methods in Political Science and International Relations, Volume 2, Chapter 41, pp. 769–804. Thousand Oaks, CA: SAGE Publications. DOI: 10.4135/9781526486387.n44

ARTICLES UNDER REVIEW

Leavitt, T., J. Bowers, and L. W. Miratrix. Sequential Sensitivity Analysis for Multiple Assumptions: A Framework for Understanding Racial Disparity in Police Use of Force. Revise & resubmit (second round) at *Journal of the American Statistical Association*. arXiv:2605.21893

STATISTICAL SOFTWARE

Leavitt, T., Hatfield, L., & Greifer, N. (2025). `apm`: Averaged Prediction Models. R package version 0.1.1. DOI: 10.32614/CRAN.package.apm. Documentation: tl2624.github.io/apm/

OTHER WRITINGS

Zeldow, B., T. Leavitt and L. A. Hatfield. Difference-in-Differences. diff.healthpolicydatascience.org

INVITED AND COMPETITIVE PRESENTATIONS

Teaching Excellence Week: Inclusive Pedagogy Showcase *Nov 2026*
Panelist
Center for Teaching and Learning
Baruch College, CUNY

Invited Session *Nov 2026*
"Robust Causal Inference Under Real-World Complications"
SLDS 2026 Conference on Statistical Learning and Data Science
ASA Section on Statistical Learning and Data Science

Arnold Ventures Criminal Justice Network Feedback Session *Oct 2026*
Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP)
Department of Political Science
University of Toronto

Data Science Frontiers: Society and Politics *Oct 2025*
New York University (NYU) Abu Dhabi Institute
NYU Abu Dhabi

Methods Workshop *Nov 2024*
Department of Political Science
Vanderbilt University

Data Science Cluster Meeting *Apr 2024*
Baruch College, CUNY

Political Methodology Colloquium *Feb 2024*
Department of Political Science
Columbia University

Winter Workshop on Causal Inference and its Applications *Jan 2024*
Departments of Statistics and Economics
University of Florida

Department of Political Science *Oct 2023*
Washington University in St. Louis

Invited Paper Session *Aug 2023*
"Planning observational studies with unobserved confounding in mind"
Joint Statistical Meetings

Data Science Lunch Seminar Series *Mar 2023*
The Center for Data Science
New York University

Conference of the ERCIM WG on Computational and Methodological Statistics (15th) *Dec 2022*
CFE-CMStatistics
King's College London

Applied Statistics Workshop *Oct 2022*
The Institute for Quantitative Social Science
Harvard University

Quantitative Methods Workshop *Oct 2022*
Wilf Family Department of Politics
New York University

Pre-APSA Workshop *Sep 2022*
"Knowledge Accumulation and External Validity: Implications for Design and Analysis"
Evidence in Governance and Politics (EGAP)
Centre for the Study of Democratic Citizenship (CSDC)
McGill University

The Miratrix C.A.R.E.S. Lab *Mar 2021*
Graduate School of Education and Department of Statistics
Harvard University

Columbia Business School and Chazen Institute for Global Business *Jan 2020*
Columbia University

Quantitative Methods Workshop *Apr 2019*
Wilf Family Department of Politics
New York University

TEACHING

Quantitative Methods 2: Statistical Theory and Causal Inference (Doctoral) *Spring 2027*
Political Science Department
Columbia University

Applied Quantitative Research II (Doctoral) *Fall 2026*
Political Science Department
The Graduate Center, CUNY

Causal Inference for the Social Sciences (Doctoral) *Summers 2018–2024, 2026*
ICPSR Summer Program
University of Michigan

Data Collection and Description (Master's) *Spring 2027*
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Public Affairs Capstone Seminar (Master's) *Fall 2026*
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Advanced Quantitative Methods (Master's) *Fall 2024, Spring 2025*
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Causal Analysis and Inference (Master's) *Spring 2024, Fall 2024, Spring 2025*
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Data Analysis for Public Service (Master's) *Fall 2023, Spring 2024*
Marxe School of Public and International Affairs
Baruch College, CUNY

Political Systems of Africa (Undergraduate) *Spring 2018*
Political Science Department
City College of New York, CUNY

SERVICE

Referee

The American Political Science Review; The American Statistician (2x); Journal of Causal Inference; Observational Studies; Philosophy of Science; Political Analysis (4x); Political Science Research and Methods; Statistics in Medicine

Marxe School of Public and International Affairs

Assessor, Program Learning Assessment (HEA and MPA) *AY 2025–26*
Member, Learning Assessment Committee *AY 2023–24, 2024–25*
Peer Teaching Observer (PAF 9335, PAF 9134, PAF 4401) *AY 2023–24, 2024–25*

Columbia University

Coordinator, Methods Workshop *AY 2016–17*
President, Political Science Graduate Student Council (PSGSC) *AY 2015–16*
Coordinator, Contemporary African Political Economy Research Seminar (CAPERS) *Fall 2015*

⋆ *Note: HEA = Higher Education Administration; MPA = Master of Public Administration.*

GRANTS AND FELLOWSHIPS

Winter Workshop Travel Award *2024*
Department of Statistics and Department of Economics
University of Florida

American Causal Inference Conference (ACIC) Junior Researcher Grant *2022*
National Science Foundation (NSF)

Dissertation Development Grant *2018*
Department of Political Science
Columbia University

Proposal Development Grant *2017*
The Abdul Latif Jameel Poverty Action Lab (J-PAL)
Massachusetts Institute of Technology

Student Research Grant *2016*
Center for Development Economics and Policy (CDEP)
Columbia University

Seed Grant *2015*
Center for the Study of Development Strategies (CSDS)
Columbia University

ADDITIONAL TRAINING

Research Certifications

CITI Program (Collaborative Institutional Training Initiative)

Responsible Conduct of Research — *Sep 2026*

Human Subjects Research (Social and Behavioral) — *Sep 2026*

Pedagogical Training

HyFlex Seminar — *Spring 2025*
Center for Teaching and Learning, Baruch College, CUNY

Seminar on Inclusive Pedagogy — *Spring 2024*
Bernard L. Schwartz Communication Institute, Baruch College, CUNY

Professional Development

Understanding the Jewish Experiences and Antisemitism — *Jan 2024*
NYC Commission on Human Rights

Human Rights Law, Racism and Other Forms of Discrimination Based on Race and Color — *Dec 2023*
NYC Commission on Human Rights

At-Risk Mental Health for Faculty & Staff — *Sep 2023*
Kognito

Graduate Coursework

ICPSR Summer Program in Quantitative Methods, University of Michigan

Maximum Likelihood Estimation I: Generalized Linear Models — *2013*

Regression Analysis II: Linear Models — *2012*

Introduction to Statistics and Data Analysis I and II — *2012*

Mandatory CUNY and New York State Trainings — *Current as of AY 2026–27*

Ethics, Cybersecurity Awareness, Workplace Violence Prevention, ESPARC, and Title VI

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages	R (including tidyverse), Stan, Wolfram Language
Development	Git and GitHub, R package development (CRAN), Shiny
Authoring	LaTeX, R Markdown and Quarto